

The world's largest scientific society, American Chemical Society, has featured the cover story on polymer, or plastic, batteries in the current edition of Chemical and Engineering News (C&EN).

The flexible batteries will not only be powerful but lightweight. It will reportedly be made out of safe materials and may be used even in electric vehicles and other transportation apps.

Obake: An elastic touchscreen

You are aware about touchscreen displays and 3D displays. But have you come across one that combines the two? A flexible screen into which you can literally sink your fingers?

Dhairya Dand and Rob Hemsley of MIT's media lab have designed Obake, a screen comprising a flexible rubber sheet laid over a set of actuators.

"The touchscreen basically amounts to an interactive display on top of an elastic surface. When you poke or pull at the display, depth cameras measure your movements and tell linear actuators to manipulate the elastic surface accordingly," said a media report.

Chargeable solar lanterns

Panasonic has developed a solar lantern that can act as a charger too. This is especially useful for people in areas with electricity issues.

With a built-in rechargeable battery



to store solar energy during the day, the lantern provides light at night and can also be used as a power source to charge small mobile devices like mobile phones. The company plans to bring

the lantern to the market in autumn this year after conducting marketing research in off-grid areas in Asia and Africa, IT Wire reported.

A solar power-based rural electrification project

Envairor Consulting Services, an Indian environment and renewable energy consulting organisation, is all set to launch its solar power-based rural electrification project in India. Envairor will be launching this project under its POA umbrella titled-Program of Activities under 'Akshay Urja - Gram Sumrudhhi' solar power-based rural electrification project with UNFCCC under the CDM as per Kyoto Protocol.

The company aims to develop, showcase and implement technologies and processes of comprehensive development of the rural and under-developed communities in India. As a part of those processes, the company has partnered with the privately held organisations to install over 50,000 solar street lights across all Indian villages by 2020 in this multi-phase project.

Magnetic graphene to revolutionise electronics

Magnets, they say form the crux of the universe. If that is true, scientists at the IMDEA-Nanociencia Institute and from Autonoma and Complutense Universities of Madrid (Spain), have managed to stumble upon what could well be the redefining factor in at least the universe of electronics.

According to a recent research paper, published in the journal, Nature Physics, these scientists claim that they have managed to inject magnetic properties in graphene. This discovery could well be the landmark which allows the joint development of graphene-based spintronic machines. Simply put, this signifies devices that work on the principle of electron rotation.

3D printing to help the blind 'see' art

A group of Harvard students is working to facilitate the visually challenged peo-

ple to enjoy art like everyone else. They have started working on a project called 'Midas Touch', which is going to make use of 3D printing to let the visually challenged people 'see' art pieces.

Midas Touch is a simple concept that will get regular flat paintings printed into 3D with textured layers on the top. This 3D printing will help the visually impaired touch and feel the art.

Amazon working on a 3D smartphone

For over a year there have been rumours about Amazon's smartphone. Now finally a report by The Wall Street Journal has confirmed that the rumours were indeed true. According to the report, Amazon is developing a wide-range of gadgets which includes two smartphones, out of which one will sport a 3D screen.

The Journal quoted multiple anonymous sources that said that the 3D-capable smartphone won't require any special glasses and will let users navigate by their eye gestures, which means that the device will be capable of tracking a user's retina, and the images will appear as if floating above the screen. Samsung was earlier trying to work on a similar technology but was proven unsuccessful.

Now open websites on chrome using gmail iOS apps

The world is a funny place. There are many users out there who prefer iPhone for its premium experience but still opt for Google-centric services like Chrome, YouTube etc. And now Google has made it easy for those users as the company has rolled its latest app update for Gmail on iOS.

The latest update offers links to Google apps that open directly by clicking on the link available. You can tap on YouTube, Maps, or basic websites to surf, which will skip Safari in favour of Chrome, which has been built by Google (install them if you haven't). So, what this means is, YouTube links on Gmail will open in the YouTube app; location links will open in Google Maps, and standard URLs will open in Google Chrome.

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